

SURVIVOR'S CHECKLIST

The things that need to be done when a loved one passes away. Please keep this with your important papers and use it as reference.



IMMEDIATE

- Obtain signed death certificate. Autopsy?
- First 24 hours. Organ donation? Check for signed authorizations and arrange immediately.
- Inventory safe deposit boxes and personal papers of the deceased. Look for any organ donation authorizations, burial insurance policies, prepaid mortuary, or cremation society plan.
- Contact mortuary to make burial or cremation and funeral arrangements. Arrange for obituary notice.
- Contact friends and relatives. ALLOW YOUR FRIENDS AND RELATIVES TO HELP YOU OUT IN THIS TIME OF NEED.
- Make arrangements for pets (if any).
- Cancel regular elder assistance services, if any (such as Meals on Wheels).
- Obtain certified copies of the death certificate from the mortuary (consider purchasing 10 to 20 copies).

WITHIN NEXT 30 DAYS

- If applicable, notify:
 - Social Security Administration to stop checks.
 - Department of Health services if the deceased was receiving Medi-Cal.
 - Veterans Administration.
 - Payers of any pensions (such as a former employer), or annuities.
 - Department of Motor Vehicles.
- Locate documents such as: a will, Trust(s), insurance policies, and deeds to real estate.
- If there was a Living Trust, **CONTACT**:
 - Successor Trustee (Trust Manager) for eventual distribution of assets.
 - **COMPANY NAME (800) 000-0000** for review of possible death and/or income taxes owing, and assistance in sorting out and distributing assets.
 - Insurance companies and arrange for any death benefits to be paid to beneficiaries.
 - IRA and pension companies for any death benefits to be paid to beneficiaries.
- If there was NO Trust and only a will, **CONTACT**:
 - County Clerk and deposit the original will within 30 days.
 - Executor to begin the probate process with an attorney.
 - **COMPANY NAME (800) 000-0000** for review of possible death and/or income taxes owing, and assistance in sorting out and distributing assets.

WITHIN NEXT 60 DAYS

- Notify all creditors and utility companies.
- Transfer title on jointly held assets.
- Inventory personal effects and arrange for disposition to family members, friends, or charities.

WITHIN SIX MONTHS

- IF SURVIVING SPOUSE:
 - **Contact COMPANY NAME (800) 000-0000** for review of finances and revised financial game plan (e.g. Replace a lost pension, increase safety of remaining assets, etc...)
- Update your will or Trust.